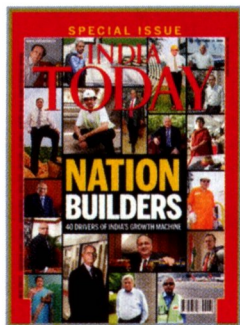


Nation Builders

OCTOBER 19, 2009

Forty drivers of the Indian growth machine show how infrastructure is the engine.



“Rare feats of excellence in infrastructure by these men and women have helped translate the nation’s vision into reality. Their achievements are an oasis amid a desert of stories on venality and corruption.”

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, via www.indiatoday.in

Making India

They are indeed the builders of our nation. (“Nation Builders”, October 19). If E. Sreedharan (DMRC), Uttam Khobragade (BEST), K. Ravi Kumar (BHEL), K.P. Singh (DLF), Deepak Parekh (HDFC) and A.M. Naik (L&T), just to name a few, had not been there to take charge and bring about a sea change with their efforts, India would not have witnessed this kind of development. They have displayed great temperament despite the bureaucracy and corruption proving to be roadblocks for these pioneering figures.

PRASHANT RAJPUT, *Mumbai*

Your focus on organisations that have contributed to the growth of the nation is a commendable effort. Most of these organisations, however,



Rebellion in the Ranks

The phenomenon of rebel contenders for an electoral role is the last flicker of revolt by independent aspirants against the increasing thrust of dynastic succession in the nation’s politics (“Rebels with a Cause”, October 19). Political power is likely to be embedded in a limited number of families, across parties, constituting a new hereditary ruling class—the nouveau-Kshatriya. This will be in accord with our caste-oriented ethos and need not be sniffed at because it is not so in *vilayat*.

BISHAN SAHAL, via www.indiatoday.in

Favouritism, nepotism, corruption, unethical agreements and alliances with sinister intentions to usurp power are the constituents of the Pandora’s box of the prevalent politics of our country. The question of consternation is how our democratic system will be cured from the cancerous disease shrouding the realpolitik.

INDU SHANKAR, via www.indiatoday.in

have a long way to go before they can compete on a global scale. The Delhi Metro project, for instance, has suffered from lack of proper planning. Consequently, it has had to deal with frequent mishaps. Similarly, India Post may be a pioneering effort but it too suffers due to governmental red-tapism. What needs to change is the way we manage these organisations. With proper management techniques, it is possible to achieve a lot within the existing framework.

AMBAR MALLICK, *Kolkata*

Thanks a lot for introducing the real nation builders. In the absence of such a detailed introduction, some people ended up worshipping the false nation builders—the corrupt politicians who are proving to be nation-eaters. These people are

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